

L&D Administrative Tasks: Setting up the Training

1. Open an issue on the Growth and Development issue board to organize sign ups and manager approval

1. Here is an example of a past issue

1. When cohort is full, create Google sheet to organize participant information

1. Tag the Total Rewards team on the issue with the participant user sheet and request that the license costs are added to their Growth and Development budget totals. Close the issue.

1. Email Crucial Learning and request an order form for the licenses needed. Indicate the start date as the day you'll have team members sign up for the course (1 week before self paced learning starts)

1. Open a Coupa request for the purchase of the licenses

1. Upload the order form in Coupa and request a legal stamp

1. Send order form with legal stamp for signature from Finance using DocuSign

1. Re-upload the signed order form to Coupa and send the signed order form back to Crucial Learning

1. When prepared, download the Purchase Order (PO) PDF from Coupa and email it to Crucial Learning

1. Crucial Learning will send back the invoice via email. Forward that email to AP with a note and link to the related req in Coupa

1. Send email and Slack message to all participants with instructions on how to activate their license. Crucial Learning will send an email teplate for this.

1. Use the Crucial Conversations Course Manager Tool and [Course Manager Guide].

1. Add all cohort participants to the crucial-conversations Slack channel

1. Add all participants to the live event calendar invites

1. Create a subfolder in the Crucial Conversations Google Drive to organize cohort materials

1. Use the live session template to organize GitLab-customized Crucial Conversation scenarios for each live session

Slack Training

Learning Objectives

GitLab team members participating in this training will:

1. Build confidence in their ability to use Slack as a form of informal and formal communication at GitLab.

1. Improve efficiency using tools built into the Slack app.

1. Review and reinforce GitLab values within the scope of Slack.

Requirements

1. You're a GitLab team member (this is not available to external learners)

1. You can commit ~5 minutes per day for 10 business days to review and take action on tasks in Slack

1. You commit to completing a post-training Google form to provide feedback on your experience

No prior experience with Slack or GitLab is needed to participate. The content reviewed is directed to brand new users in the GitLab Slack instance, however, team members are welcome to participate regardless of time at the company.

If you meet these requirements, please use this Google form to sign-up.

Training Details

Here's what to expect in the Slack training:

1. After signing up, you'll be added to a training cohort Slack group and the slack-training Slack channel. The current goal is to run at least one cohort per month.
1. The training will run for 10 business days.
1. Each day, you'll get one Slack group ping with your daily task instructions, posted publicly to the slack-training channel.
1. Messages will be scheduled by the L&D team and are triggered to send at 3pm UTC.
1. On the final day of the training, you'll be asked to complete an end of program survey to share your feedback and learning from the training.

Topics Covered

Below you'll find the topics and links covered in each day of the training

Training Day	Topic	Links
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0	Training introduction + Slack profile updates	N/A
1	Organizing channels in the Slack side-bar	Custom section Slack docs
2	Using public channels	Why we avoid direct messages at GitLab
3	Marking all messages as read	Quick commands Slack docs
4	Follow keywords in Slack	Custom notifications Slack docs
5	Using threads to organize conversations	Slack usage at GitLab
6	Review of here and channel tag usage	Reducing reliance on Slack at GitLab
7	Blocking time to catch up on Slack messages	Do not Distrub mode Slack docs
8	Using the /remind command	Remind command Slack docs
9	Moving conversations out of Slack and into Issues or MRs	Slack usage at GitLab
10	End of training survey	N/A

Metrics

We measure success using the following metrics:

Metrics	How we measure	Goal
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	Percentage of new team members who complete the training per quarter	Completions of end of program survey 30%

Future improvements

The following topics will be prioritized in future iterations of this training:

1. Increase automation - explore tools and plugins that can automatically assign and trigger this training based on team member start date
1. Improve metrics - track impact of training on team member behavior in Slack
1. Create a Slack training 2.0

Learning Speaker Series

The L&D team hosts quarterly Learning Speaker Series open to all team members. The calls provide a space where internal and external experts can share relevant topics to engage and teach team members lessons learned from their own careers.

Goals

1. Provide a forum where team members can learn from established leaders and industry experts.

Past Learning Speaker Series calls

FY23 Q3 Series: Emotional Intelligence

Date	Session Title + Link
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2022-09-20	Being Human with Claire Doody
2022-10-19	Diversity in Emotional Intelligence with Reini Chipman
2022-10-24	Emotional Intelligence for Modern Leaders with Christopher Connors
2022-11	Trust and Know your Audience with Camilla Boyer

FY23 Q2 Series: Collaborating with Compassion

Date	Session Title + Link
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2022-05-11	Mental Health Awareness Month Discussion with Britt Turpack + 8 Minute Meditation
2022-06-22	Self Compassion Practice with Dulce Orozco
2022-07-20	Compassionate Feedback with Maria Moss and Feedback Exercise Resource

FY23 Q1 Series: All-Remote Communication

This series included a mix of 5 internal and external speakers. The session recordings and topics can be found below. You can also find all recordings collected together on this [GitLab Unfiltered YouTube Channel Playlist](#).

Date	Session Title + Link
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2022-01-20	Video and All-Remote Presentation Tips with Lorraine Lee, Prezi
2022-02-14	Understanding Tone in Text-Based Communication with Maria Moss
2022-03-09	Communicating your All-Remote Career Development with Lavinia Mehedintu
2022-03-24	Internal Panel - Cross-Cultural Communication at GitLab
2022-04-13	Managing Information Overload with Joana Pais Afonso

FY22 Series

Date	Session Title + Link
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2021-06-01	Building your Rest Ethic with John Fitch Session 1 and Session 2
2021-11-18	Building Internal Culture with Google Team Members

| 2021-12-13 | Managing Burnout with Skylyte |
| 2021-12-14 | Well-being Week with Krystal Wilkinson |

FY21 Series

Date	Session Title + Link
2020-11-19	Building Trust with Remote Teams Learning Speaker Series
2020-12-10	Managing Burnout with Time Off with John Fitch

Hosting a Learning Speaker Series call

The following process outlines steps for the L&D team to take when planning and implementing the calls.

Planning Issue Template: Open a learning-speaker-series issue template in the L&D General Project to host a session. Steps outlined below are also included in the issue template and are included here as reference.

1. Collaborate with exec team, mid-level people leaders, and other interested GitLab Team members to gauge interest and availability to be featured in the call. Be mindful to include diverse voices from across the GitLab team.
1. Plan on a quarterly basis if possible. Create a series based on a topic that is high need for managers or ICs at GitLab.
1. Ensure external speakers have been validated and that the topic covered aligns with our values.
1. Create a calendar event and share it with the GitLab Team Meetings calendar. Invite the everyone alias. Post in the people-connect Slack channel to accept event on the team meetings calendar. Consider hosting the call at least 2 times, or varying session times throughout a quarterly series, to accommodate for multiple time zones.
1. Test Zoom functionality with the speaker at least two business days before event.
 - If external speaker, ensure they have downloaded Zoom.
 - Have speaker test audio and video.
 - Check that speaker will be able to share a presentation if necessary.
1. Send speaker calendar invite with all details for the call (including, but not limited to, Zoom link, agenda, slides, etc.).
1. Create an agenda for the presentation. GitLab team members can access templates in this Google folder.
1. Coordinate an announcement of the call in the what's-happening-at-GitLab Slack channel at least 1 business day before the call.
1. Use Canva to create internal marketing that features each speaker's headshot and session title.

Learning Sessions

Live Learning

Live Learning sessions are conducted on an ad hoc. There will be a Zoom video conference set up for each session. Official dates and topics will be added to the schedule below as confirmed. If you were unable to attend a live learning session but still want to learn, check out our

past live learning sessions below. At GitLab we give agency, but if you are attending Live Learning sessions, you will be asked to be engaged and participate with your full attention.

{{% details summary="Format for Live Learning Sessions" %}}

Format for 25 minute sessions:

- 10 minutes - introduction/content
- 10-15 minutes - Q&A

Format for 50 minute sessions (times below are approximate):

- 10-15 minutes - introduction/content
- 10-20 minutes - breakout session
- 10-20 minutes - debrief
- 5 minutes - conclusion

{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Past Live Learning Sessions" %}}

2020

- January - Compensation Review: Manager Cycle (Compaas)
- January - Ally Training
- February - Receiving Feedback
- June - Delivering Feedback
- June - Recognizing Bias
- September - Manager Challenge Pilot
- November - Belonging
- November - One Week Challenge - Psychological Safety
- December - Introduction to Coaching

2019

- November - Communicating Effectively & Responsibly Through Text
- December - Inclusion Training

{{% /details %}}

Social Learning Through Live Learning

Social Learning is the cornerstone for how L&D designs, develops, and delivers live learning sessions. Social learning focuses on how team members interact with peers for just-in-time learning and skill acquisition through knowledge retention. Live learnings serve as an opportunity for team members to build relationships and a sense of community with team members. Social Learning occurs when team members come together in a virtual forum synchronously to learn from others through networking, breakout groups, storytelling, lessons learned reflection, and collaboration on solving scenarios with role playing. The live learnings enables learners to pull knowledge from experts and peers within the organization instead of

having knowledge pushed to them.

Example of a Social Learning Live Learning Session on Building High Performing Teams

{{< youtube "aezVF1nOBWc" >}}

Social Learning can also occur in GitLab's Learning Experience Platform - Level Up and asynchronous forums using GitLab. (i.e. Elevate)

Learning & Development Quarterly Newsletter

The L&D team hosted a quarterly newsletter for five quarters for the community.

Take Time Out To Learn Campaign

Focus Friday's are a great benefit at GitLab. We try to schedule minimal meetings on Fridays to catch up on work and grow our skills professionally. Use Focus Fridays to take time out to learn. Team members can work with their manager through a career development conversation to determine what skills that want to grow in the future. Aspirations can be documented in an individual growth plan.

From there, identify what will be needed to attain the new skills and consider using the Growth and Development Benefit or expensing professional development opportunities such as coaching, workshops, conferences, self-service learning, etc.. Block time off your calendar every week or month to devote to learning new skills. Share what you are learning with team members and in the learninganddevelopment slack channel.

Consider documenting the steps you are going to take learn new skills in the individual growth plan. Check in with your manager and ask for accountability from them to help you stay aligned with goals.

Internal Learning Campaigns

Learning campaigns at GitLab have an asynchronous focus and are used to raise awareness around a specific topic or set of resources. These campaigns are inspired by the structure of a learning challenge but without the required engagement or tracking. For example, the L&D team is using a learning campaign structure to host a mental health awareness week

Learning campaigns use a combination of GitLab issues and Slack announcements to raise awareness and spark discussion. Following the campaign, the L&D team will aggregate comments and resources that have surfaced and document in the handbook. Learning campaigns can be used to build buzz around a live speaker series or to start conversation about a common question or issue that GitLab team members are facing.

CEO Handbook Learning Sessions

GitLab's Handbook pages grow every day. Throughout FY22, the L&D team and the CEO held recorded learning sessions to analyze Handbook pages. The goal of the sessions will be to incorporate more video-based learning into the handbook.

Three types of CEO handbook learning sessions:

1. Handbook Readout: Bite-sized recording where the L&D team and the CEO review what is on the page. (5 minute video)

1. Handbook Discussion: Interactive discussion where L&D facilitates an engaging conversation with the CEO and e-group members. We openly discuss the concepts on the page and allow senior leaders to share best practices implementing them. (25 minute video)

1. Handbook Interview: The Learning and Development team will create new pages, create sub-pages, or update existing pages based on interview topics discussed during a targeted Q&A. The video will serve as the foundation for new learning content at GitLab.

The video below from Sid and L&D further explains the concepts:

{{< youtube "cB301JaYnsw" >}}

Steps for L&D Team when setting up a CEO Handbook Learning Session:

Preparing for the Call:

1. Review topic relevant Handbook pages.

1. Determine what topics you want to cover each week

1. Research the respective page that will be discussed or section of a page

1. Complete some work on the page before the session if you can, create an MR that clarifies information or asks Sid for clarity on the topic discussed.

1. Set up a meeting with CEO through EBA. Invite other e-group members if applicable.

1. Create an agenda with talking points and areas to emphasize during video recording with CEO

1. Send Sid the agenda in the CEO channel at least 24 hours in advance

1. Hold a handbook learning session and ensure the discussion is fluid and interactive with open and honest dialogue.

During the Call:

1. Give CEO and other speakers, if applicable, a few minutes at the beginning of the call to populate answers.

1. Once everyone is ready, stream to YouTube Live.

1. Make the title of the agenda, the same as the YouTube Video.

1. Do a quick introduction.

1. Go through the questions on the agenda.

1. If questions come up during the interview, add them to the end of the agenda if there is time

1. When there's nothing on the agenda left, thank him for his time and end the live stream.

After the Call:

1. Determine if L&D can create bite-sized videos with the content. Post bite-sized and long-form video on YouTube Unfiltered channel

1. Update Unfiltered page with more information after the Live Stream. See the description in this example video.

1. Edit the live stream thumbnail with a Title Page for each topic. Here is the template for the videos. Write out a new title, screenshot the image, and update thumbnail.

1. Embed video on the related Handbook page.
1. Edit page with new content, create sub-page, send MR in the CEO channel with a proposal for an interactive handbook discussion.

List of CEO Handbook Learning Sessions

Playlist

1. Common misperceptions about Iteration
1. No Matrix Organization
1. Making Decisions
1. Individual Contributor Leadership
1. Bias Towards Asynchronous Communication
1. High Output Management
1. Giving and Receiving Feedback
1. Managing Underperformance
1. Transitioning from IC to Manager - Engineering
1. Manager Mention Merge Requests
1. Working Groups
1. Skip Level Meetings
1. Product Strategy
1. Mental Wellness Discussion

FY22 Topic Outline

This is the list of topics that were covered in FY22.

- April: Managing Stress
- May: Effective Communication
- June: Coaching
- July: Culture of Feedback
- August: Career Development
- September: Manager of One
- October: Emotional Intelligence
- November: Gratitude and Recognition
- December: Resilience and Reflection
- January: Team Member Well-being

FY23 Topic Outline

This is the list of topics that will be focused on in FY23.

- February: Setting and Achieving Goals
- March: Managing High Performing Teams: Orientation
- April: Managing High Performing Teams: Building Trust
- May: Managing Mental Health at Work
- June: Allyship
- July: (Suspended due to learning system transition)
- August: (Suspended due to learning system transition)
- September: Creativity

Organizing a Skill of the Month

The following process outlines steps for the L&D team to take when planning and implementing the Skill of the Month.

Anyone or any team can recommend a topic for the future! If interested, please fill out a Learning & Development Request template to begin the process.

Planning Issue Template: Open a skill-of-the-month issue template in the L&D General Project. Steps are outlined in the issue template.

Learning Resource: Building Resilience

This Building Resilience learning resource is available to help team members understand and build resilience. It also highlights additional resources to support team members' well-being, mental health, and growth of resilience.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/learning-initiatives/radical-candor.md

Radical Candor on High Performing Teams

At GitLab, high performing teams collaborate with open and effective communication. To strengthen this skill across the organization, we're bringing the Radical Candor communication framework to GitLab. Radical Candor focuses on building trust, another pillar of high performing teams at GitLab, and using that trust to foster effective collaboration through conflict.

Learners will experience Radical Candor in a semi-synchronous program, with time spent in self paced training, async Slack discussion, and live practice.

What is Radical Candor?

<iframe width="560" height="315"
src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/OoISfhACm4s?si=jXe5oqgu6D0HCRm" title="YouTube video player" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; clipboard-write; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-origin-when-cross-origin" allowfullscreen></iframe>

On her website, Kim Scott, the creator of Radical Candor, describes the framework as this:

>Your entire working life you've been told to be professional. Too often, that's code for leaving your humanity at home. To build strong relationships, you have to Care Personally. This can be as simple as showing enough vulnerability to admit when you're having a bad day and creating a safe place for others to do the same.

>Since you learned to talk you've likely been told some version of, 'If you don't have anything nice to say, don't say anything at all.' Then you become the boss and the very thing you've been taught not to do since you were 18 months old is suddenly your job. In order to succeed, you have to Challenge Directly. Challenging people is often the best way to show you care. It does not mean that whatever you think is the truth; it means you share your (humble) opinions

directly.

>Radical Candor happens when you put these two things together to give feedback that's kind, clear, specific and sincere.

Enrollment

In partnership with MasterClass@Work, GitLab's Talent Development team is hosting a pilot for 50 team members to dive deeply into caring personally and challenging directly.

By signing up, you agree to spend approx. 45 minutes per week for the 6 week course.

Sign ups are closed as of 2024-11-01. For information about the next Radical Candor cohort, reach out in the learninganddevelopment Slack channel.

Course Details

Radical Candor at GitLab embraces a semi-synchronous learning model, including a mix of self-paced learning, live practice, and async discussion. Review the detailed course requirements below.

| Course Element | Description |

| ---- | ----- |

| Self-Paced Course | Complete a 3 hour, self-paced course in MasterClass, led by Kim Scott, founder of Radical Candor. |

| Practice Session | Meet for two 25-minute practice sessions with other learners. In breakout groups, discuss concepts of Radical Candor and practice scenario-based discussions. |

| Threads | Contribute to thought-provoking conversation in Slack around bringing Radical Candor to life at GitLab |

Timeline

Refer to the timeline below for a breakdown of each course requirement, as well as an outline of what self-paced material should be finished by each date in order to fully participate in the live and async discussions.

| Date | Learner Expectation |

| ----- | ----- |

| Week of 2024-11-04 | Activate your MasterClass@Work access via email invite; Begin self-paced course |

| 2024-11-07 | Contribute to Thread 1 in Slack |

| 2024-11-13 | Contribute to Threads 2 in Slack |

| By 2024-11-18 | Complete sections 1 through 4 of the self-paced course: Introduction, Understand Radical Candor, Ask for and Recieve Feedback and Offer Powerful Praise |

| Week of 2024-11-18 | Attend Practice Session 1 |

| 2024-11-26 | Contribute to Thread 3 in Slack |

| By 2024-12-02 | Complete sections 5 through 8 of the self-paced course: Give Criticism Effectively, Gauge How your Feedback Lands, Put Radical Candor to Work, and Cultivate a Candid Culture |

| Week of 2024-12-02 | Attend Practice Session 2 |

| By 2024-12-13 | Complete all self-paced course work |

Practice Sessions

Plan to attend Practice Session 1 and Practice Session 2, offered during Week 3 and 5 of the course.

Practice Session 1

Attend one session, and come prepared to discuss and practice with concepts from the self-paced work, including:

Introduction, Understand Radical Candor, Ask for and Recieve Feedback and Offer Powerful Praise.

1. 2024-11-19 @ 1am UTC (best for APAC)
2. 2024-11-20 @ 1pm UTC (best for EMEA)
3. 2024-11-21 @ 11pm UTC (best for west AMER)
4. 2024-11-22 @ 6:30pm UTC (best for east AMER)

Practice Session 2

Attend one session, and come prepared to discuss and practice with concepts from the self-paced work, including:

Give Criticism Effectively, Gauge How your Feedback Lands, Put Radical Candor to Work, and Cultivate a Candid Culture.

1. 2024-12-03 @ 1am UTC (best for APAC)
2. 2024-12-04 @ 1pm UTC (best for EMEA)
3. 2024-12-04 @ 11pm UTC (best for west AMER)
4. 2024-12-06 @ 6:30pm UTC (best for east AMER)

Additional Program Requirements

1. Radical Candor is open to all team members at GitLab.
1. Enrollment is first-come, first served. Once the 50-person cohort is full, we'll create a waiting list.
1. By 2024-11-18, if you've not activated your MasterClass license, your seat may be reassigned to someone on the waitlist.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/level-up/_index.md

Leveling Up LevelUp

We're currently rolling out a new platform for LevelUp to better support the pace, demand, complexity, and culture of GitLab. This overhaul will allow team members to engage around learning in a completely different way, that links in with Talent, career pathing, project opportunities, and more.

Learning today goes way beyond self-paced content, far passed webinars, leaps above documents; learning is much much more. And GitLab's new "LevelUp" (integrated talent EXPERIENCE platform)

will show you just how dynamic learning, growth, skills development, and performance can go.

Consider this page your LevelUp information highway. Over the coming weeks, you'll see updates, announcements, and rollout plans here.

What's the difference between LevelUp and GitLab University?

With the launch of this new technology solution, it's important to note that LevelUp and GitLab University are now two completely separate platforms, each with a different purpose and audience. GitLab University is used for customer education, whereas LevelUp is designed to support team member learning and professional development.

| | GitLab University | LevelUp |

|---|---|---|

| Target Audience | Designed for educating customers and community members | Designed for educating internal team members |

| Platform | Runs on Thought Industries Learning System | Runs on Cornerstone Talent Experience Platform |

| Training Type | Delivers external-facing product training | Delivers internal training for team members - including product, professional development, and compliance training |

If you'd like to take any courses / certifications that are currently hosted on GitLab University, don't worry, we'll make them accessible via LevelUp.

Benefits and Features

The new Cornerstone Talent Experience Platform (TXP) offers significant improvements over our current learning management system, and is specifically designed to support internal employee development and career growth at GitLab. Key features include:

- Internal gigs and side projects to provide hands-on learning opportunities
- Enhanced management tools for training assignment and recommendations
- Advanced user-generated content capabilities
- Seamless integration with our talent management infrastructure, ensuring skills development is reflected in performance data
- Skills library linked to GitLab job architecture

Project Team

- Tre Ely - Sr Director Talent Management & Development
- Jamie Allen - Sr Talent Development Program Manager
- Michelle Bencomo - Sr Program Manager, People Leadership Group

Timeline

The system is currently live for our engineering and security divisions, details on the company wide rollout to follow, but all team members will have access by the end of Q2.

FAQs

- I completed a number of learning courses in the Legacy platform, what will happen to my learning data?
- Your learning history may not be migrated when you first login to the new LevelUp system, but all team members' learning data is preserved, and will be migrated as the system over the next weeks and months, team members don't need to take any action.
- You do not need to retake any courses you've already completed.
- I've noticed something in the new system that isn't working properly, or would like to give feedback on a platform feature, who should I tell?
- Please share any feedback in the LevelUp feedback issue here.
- When will I lose access to the legacy system?
- The legacy Level Up system uses the same vendor (Thought Industries), as GitLab University, which serves our partners and customers with GitLab product training and education content. Therefore the system won't be going away, but we will likely sunset it for team members at some point. We'll announce more when a full timeline is planned, but access won't be restricted, and it is expected to be after Q2.
- For a transition period, you'll still have access to both systems.
- Will all content be migrated to the new system?
- We are conducting a full content audit from the legacy system, and all relevant content will be migrated to the new LevelUp. If you notice something missing that should be added, please let us know in the LevelUp feedback issue here, or the learninganddevelopment slack channel.
- How do I login to the new system?
- Access will be granted via Okta - search the LevelUp Okta tile.
- I have a question about how something works in LevelUp, who should I ask?
- Please let us know in the LevelUp feedback issue here.
- I have started a course, but my progress bar shows 0% completion. Is my progress lost?
- Some courses only report completion, not the ongoing progress. The LevelUp progress bar will reflect it once you finish the course.

Platform Guide

Read on below to learn about the functionality in LevelUp, including terminology, and guides to specific features.

Watch the video below for more information on the content hierarchy in LevelUp:

```
<iframe width="560" height="315" src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/Z4QpE-Mb-nE?si=Ig0hzrIdIW0RWLJn" title="YouTube video player" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; clipboard-write; encrypted-media; gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-origin-when-cross-origin" allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Note: Following some UX updates, you can now access the 'Create' option by navigating to More > Tools > Manage Content > 'Create New', or just head to <https://levelup.edcast.com/content>

Smartcards

The basic unit of content in LevelUp. A SmartCard is a single piece of learning material like a video, article, quiz, or link to helpful resources.

> Note: By default, all users can create SmartCards, but if you're interested in putting a Pathway together, please open an access request to be a course author in LevelUp, and assign it to @jallen16, who can uplift your access permissions.

How to Create a SmartCard in LevelUp

Creating a SmartCard is simple and allows you to share valuable learning content with your team or the wider organization.

Basic Steps

1. From the LevelUp homepage, click the Create button in the top navigation bar
1. Select SmartCard from the options
1. Choose the type of content you want to share (article, video, link, etc.)
1. Add the URL or upload your content
1. Fill in the title and description
1. Set the estimated time to complete
1. Add relevant tags to make your content discoverable
1. Choose whether the content should be public or private
1. Click Create to publish your SmartCard

Best Practices

- Clear Titles: Use descriptive titles that clearly indicate what the content is about
- Add Instructions: Include a brief note telling learners what to do with the content
- Set Accurate Time Estimates: Be realistic about how long it will take to consume the content
- Use Relevant Tags: Add specific tags to help others discover your content
- Consider Privacy Settings: Create SmartCards independently (outside of pathways) if you want them to be reusable across the platform
- Add to Channels: Share your SmartCard to relevant channels to increase visibility
- Quality Over Quantity: Focus on sharing truly valuable content that addresses specific learning needs

Remember, SmartCards created within a Pathway will only be discoverable in that Pathway, while SmartCards created independently can be discovered and used across the platform.

Watch the video below for a walkthrough on how to create Smartcards:

```
<iframe width="560" height="315"
src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/tDtdp3OdFDQ?si=WcxaZNeInM1nwC4v" title="YouTube video
player" frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; clipboard-write; encrypted-media;
gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-origin-when-cross-origin"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Note: Following some UX updates, you can now access the 'Create' option by navigating to More > Tools > Manage Content > 'Create New', or just head to <https://levelup.edcast.com/content>

Smartcard Thumbnails

We have a directory of branded Smartcard thumbnails available here for team members to use for content they're creating - you can access it here.

Pathways

Collections of SmartCards organized in a sequence to help you achieve a specific learning goal. Think of a Pathway as a short course made up of individual learning pieces.

How to Create a Pathway in LevelUp

A Pathway is a collection of SmartCards organized as a learning sequence. Here's how to create one:

Basic Steps

1. From the LevelUp homepage, click the Create button in the top navigation bar
1. Select Pathway from the options
1. Fill in the basic information: Title for your Pathway, a description explaining what learners will achieve, and any relevant tags
1. Decide if your Pathway should be public or private
1. Add existing SmartCards by using the search function
1. Create new SmartCards directly within the Pathway if needed
1. Arrange SmartCards in the desired order by dragging and dropping
1. Enable "Lock" functionality if you want learners to progress in sequence
1. Add a badge if applicable for Pathway completion
1. Click Create or Save to publish your Pathway

Best Practices

- Organize content in a logical sequence from basic to advanced concepts
- Include a clear introduction at the beginning explaining what learners will gain
- Consider using Lock functionality for content that builds on previous knowledge
- Add quizzes or knowledge checks to reinforce learning
- Keep Pathways focused on a specific learning objective
- Consider ending with next steps or related Pathways

> Note: By default, all users can create SmartCards, but if you're interested in putting a Pathway together, please open an access request to be a course author in LevelUp, and assign it to @jallen16, who can uplift your access permissions.

```
<iframe width="560" height="315"
src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/muhRz69i0c?si=G3F2ukQzroGDHdAD" title="YouTube video player"
frameborder="0" allow="accelerometer; autoplay; clipboard-write; encrypted-media; gyroscope;
picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-origin-when-cross-origin"
allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Note: Following some UX updates, you can now access the 'Create' option by navigating to More > Tools > Manage Content > 'Create New', or just head to <https://levelup.edcast.com/content>

Journeys

Larger learning experiences made up of multiple Pathways. Journeys offer comprehensive learning on a topic by combining several related Pathways into chapters or sections.

Channels

Topic-based collections of content that help you discover learning materials on specific subjects. You can follow channels to stay updated when new content is added.

Groups

Communities of learners organized around teams, departments, or shared interests. Groups allow content to be shared with specific audiences.

Manager Dashboard

A tool for managers to view their team's learning activity, assign content to team members, and track progress on assigned learning materials.

Skills

In Cornerstone, skills are the metadata that describe what you can do and know - like professional DNA that the system tracks and analyzes. They help connect you with the right learning content, projects, and opportunities to grow your capabilities, in keeping with your career and development goals.

Early Access for Compliance Training

While LevelUp is being rolled out division by division, some team members outside of Engineering and Security are being granted early access to complete required compliance training. This ensures all team members can complete their mandatory training in one consistent platform. Compliance training was previously deployed through NavexENGAGE and other platforms; we will now centralize all compliance trainings on LevelUp.

What you need to know

If you've been granted early access for compliance training:

- Your access is currently limited to the compliance training section of LevelUp
- You can complete and track your assigned compliance courses
- Full platform access will be available when your division is rolled out (by end of Q2)
- You've been enrolled in:
 - Code of Conduct: Ethical decision-making and workplace guidance
 - Regulation FD: Material information handling and disclosure practices
- Due Date: (2025-07-11) July 11, 2025

Early Access FAQ

<details>

<summary>Why am I getting early access to LevelUp?</summary>

You've been granted early access specifically to complete mandatory compliance training. Rather than having different team members use different systems, we're providing limited access to LevelUp so everyone can complete their compliance training in the same platform.

</details>

<details>

<summary>What can I access with early access?</summary>

With early access, you can only access the compliance training section of LevelUp. You'll be able to view, complete, and track progress on your assigned compliance courses. Full platform features will become available when your division officially rolls out LevelUp.

</details>

<details>

<summary>When will I get full access to LevelUp?</summary>

Full access to LevelUp will be granted when we launch for your division. All team members will have access by the end of Q2. Check back on this page for updated rollout timelines.

</details>

<details>

<summary>How do I access my compliance training?</summary>

You can use the direct links provided in your enrollment email to access specific courses. You should see the email from sender: "learning@gitlab.com".

</details>

<details>

<summary>What if I can't access LevelUp or my training?</summary>

For any technical issues or access problems with the LevelUp platform, please post in the fy26-levelup-support Slack channel. The learning team will help resolve any access or technical issues.

</details>

<details>

<summary>Who do I contact for questions about the training content?</summary>

For questions about the actual content of the compliance training (not technical issues), please use the compliance-training Slack channel. The compliance team monitors this channel and can answer content-specific questions.

</details>

<details>

<summary>What happens if I don't complete the training by the due date?</summary>

Compliance training is mandatory and must be completed by July 11, 2025. You'll receive reminder notifications at regular intervals. Managers will be notified if training remains

incomplete after the due date.

</details>

<details>

<summary>Will my learning history from the legacy system transfer over?</summary>

Yes, your learning history is preserved and will be migrated to LevelUp over the coming weeks and months. You do not need to retake any courses you've already completed. The migration happens automatically - no action needed from you.

</details>

<details>

<summary>Can I access other learning content besides compliance training?</summary>

During the early access period, your access is restricted to compliance training only. Once your division officially rolls out LevelUp, you'll have access to all learning content, pathways, and platform features.

</details>

<details>

<summary>Where can I find more information about LevelUp?</summary>

For general information about LevelUp, including platform features and rollout updates, refer to the main sections of this handbook page. For immediate support, use the fy26-levelup-support Slack channel.

</details>

This section is temporary and will be removed once all divisions have full access to LevelUp.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/level-up/legacy.md

(LEGACY) Level Up

This handbook page is meant to support both learners and administrators in Level Up. Thought Industries is the provider of the Level Up platform and is mentioned often in this documentation. We're currently going through the implementation of a new version of LevelUp, using a new system - Cornerstone. We've moved this page to be titled Legacy to avoid confusion between the two systems whilst the transition is taking place. We expect the implementation to be complete sometime in Q2 FY2026. More information can be found on the main LevelUp handbook page.

Contribute to Level Up

At GitLab, everyone can contribute. Read below about how to contribute to Level Up. If you'd

like to explore the content creation options in Level Up, check out this Demo Course.

Why contribute?

Contributing to Level Up democratizes learning and enables our team members, customers, and community members to contribute to the growth of learning opportunities at GitLab. Some benefits for contributors include:

- 1. Share the work you've created to teach others how to use GitLab
- 1. Curate existing information that has helped you or others learn to use GitLab
- 1. Share information you've created about working remotely
- 1. Establish yourself as a subject matter expert within our learning community
- 1. Share learning pathways and other instructional design materials you've created
- 1. Enable organizations to learn about GitLab using innovative learning methods

Stay Tuned: Future iterations of contributions to Level Up will include elevated permissions for Learning evangelists to add new material directly to Level Up!

Learning Evangelist Training

To contribute to Level Up, there are two things to do.

First, please open an issue in the lxp-contributions project using the lxpcontribution issue template and tag Jamie Allen. We will review your training request and advise on next steps. The Learning and Development team can assist in the creation of content, or if you'd prefer, you can go through the Learning Evangelist Training so that you can create it yourself.

If you want to build the content into the platform yourself, please complete the Level Up Learning Evangelist training. This training course uses instructional videos to teach learners the basics of content creation in Level Up, and includes some best practice to think about when designing learning content and gathering materials. Once you have completed the training, the Learning and Development team will uplift your permissions in Level Up to give you access to course authoring tools.

Support

For questions not answered below, reach out in the learninganddevelopment Slack channel or open an issue.

I'm a GitLab team member and I have a question or problem related to Level Up.

- Please reach out to the learninganddevelopment Slack channel for support.

I have a question about how to use the Level Up platform.

- When you're logged into Level Up, click the drop down menu next to your profile photo and select Support. Here, you'll see both general and GitLab-specific help resources related to using Level Up. See screenshots below.

Training

1. If you have questions about Level Up functionality or capabilities, the Thought Industries Academy includes self-paced training and support articles. Access the academy by clicking the Need Help button on the left side bar when logged into Thought Industries and scroll down to Learn More in the Academy

1. Admin in Level Up can use the Help Center to report technical problems with platform directly to Thought Industries.

1. Platform Settings PDF Guide

1. You can also review the administration guide below for more information on platform capabilities.

ThoughtIndustries Administration

In this section we're recording some administrative tips for Legacy Level Up.

Management of the Learning System is a collaborative effort between Education Services, Learning & Development, Field Enablement, and Partner Teams. Each team has specific use cases for the system, and utilize the panorama functionality to target different audiences both internal and external. Below is a brief description of each use case the system is currently being utilized for.

Learning & Development

The L&D team uses Thought Industries to support training for GitLab team members, and in some instances, community members. This is achieved in accordance with our Purpose, Vision, and Mission.

Education Services

The primary mission of Education Services is to plan and implement effective and scalable educational offerings to accelerate customer time to value and drive expanding product adoption. Education Services deliver Technical Certifications via Level Up.

Field Enablement

Field Enablement's mission is to inspire the field organization and partners to achieve high levels of success through the acquisition and application of knowledge, skills and behaviors that improve productivity and accelerate growth. They utilize Level Up to deliver onboarding and digital training for Sales teams.

Platform Training and Support from Thought Industries

Thought Industries provide a number of resources that can be used for support in upskilling admins, and for answering administration questions.

Thought Industries Academy

1. The Thought Industries Academy includes self-paced training and support articles. Access the academy by clicking the Need Help button on the left side bar when logged into Thought Industries and scroll down to Learn More in the Academy.

1. Platform Settings PDF Guide

Raising a Support Ticket

Support tickets should be raised to report errors, bugs, and outages in the platform, but can also be used to ask for technical advice on platform functionality. Before raising a Support Ticket, it's recommended to look for relevant articles in the Knowledge Base that may answer the query without the need to raise a ticket. The steps to open a ticket are as follows:

1. Access the academy Knowledge Base

1. Scroll to the bottom of the page, and click Submit a Request (underneath Can't find what you're looking for?)

1. Fill in the ticket details in the fields provided and submit.

1. You will receive a response to your support request via email.

Product Enhancement Suggestions & TI Community

To make suggestions for enhancements to Thought Industries, it is recommended to utilize the Thought Industries Community site.

This video explains how the site works, and how to get signed up.

Administrator Home Page

The admin home page is a place for platform administrators to access:

1. Thought Industries announcements and feature highlights

1. Updates on new platform features, shared the last Tuesday of every month

1. Opt-in subscriptions for system updates, outages, and scheduled maintenance (suggested for all admin)

1. The Control Panel that lists all features enabled in the Level Up instance

Platform Settings

Notifications

1. Emails: Refer to this list of default emails sent to users]. Emails are branded for Level Up

Content settings

1. Content Types: Access by navigating to settings -> content -> content types. Here you can create new content types, like a module or course video that isn't already included in the standard Thought Industries content types. You cannot edit a content type once it's been used.

1. Ribbons: Use ribbons when authoring a course to communicate to the learning with types like free, featured, popular or new. Create a new ribbon by navigating to settings -> content -> organization and display.

1. Global Resource Library: These resources can be toggled on and accessed in any course. You

can upload or author PDFs, pages, videos, etc. The same resource library is shared for all courses.

1. Snippets: Frequently used HTML text that can be used across all content when authoring.
1. Add to Queue: Navigate to settings -> content -> toggle on add to queue to allow user to save content for later.

Certification and Gamification Settings

Certificates

1. Awarded upon completion of learning content
1. Establish fields for all certifications by navigating to settings -> certification
1. Level Up is provisioned so users can share certificates on LinkedIn
1. A .jpg or .jpeg blank certificate must be uploaded when authoring a course
1. When building a course, drag and drop criteria to be auto-filled into the blank certificate file

Gamification (these are gained as people earn points in the system)

1. Navigate to settings -> gamification to edit.

Points (Awards)

1. Awards in Level Up are called Points
1. Users earn points for completing certain actions. These must be configured, and are completely custom, by the GitLab team.

Badges

1. Users earn badges based on their collected points
1. Badges must be configured by GitLab team. There is an option to upload custom badges. An example could be earning the high achiever badge after earning 50,000 points.

Authoring

Level Up uses a handbook first approach for all learning content, using the handbook as our single source of truth for learning content.

This approach ensures:

- all voices and contributions are heard
- barriers to contributions are removed or reduced
- the organization maintains a single source of truth

Adding captions to videos

It's important to add captions to videos whenever possible. The steps below outline different ways this can be done based on your video format.

1. YouTube: Use a YouTube embed code to allow users to turn on captions directly on the video
1. PowToon: Use a PowToon embed code, then write the transcript of the video in a discussion

thread in the relevant lesson.

1. Native Video Upload:

1. Upload your video and either write out or obtain a text caption doc.
1. Scroll through the video to a time marker where you want to put a caption
1. Click the caption button at lower right of the video
1. Paste in a short amount of text.
1. Watch it back. You can easily edit the captions (they are listed all together below the video window) so it's not hard to adjust and make them fit.

Custom Content Fields

The Custom Content Field requirements for internal courses can be found here for GitLab team members. To add a new field, navigate to Settings -> Content -> Organization and Display.

Add custom content fields directly to each course in the Design tab.

Please review the best practices below:

Best Practices:

1. All custom content fields and sub fields are case sensitive - avoid mistakes like Communication, Communications, Communicating
1. Wherever possible, use existing custom content fields and sub fields as opposed to creating new ones
1. Review TI support docs when questions arise

Publishing a course for internal team members

1. From the admin view, navigate to the course by choosing Content > Manage Content, then finding the relevant course
1. Once in the course editor, in the Content page check all relevant changes have been published.
1. Go to the Design page then Edit Catalog Settings. Add the Internal tag and click Save
1. Your content is now visible in the internal catalogue.
1. You do not need to perform any actions on the Release page

Share a course link with team members

1. Add <https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/saml/login/internal-team-members?returnTo=> immediately before a course link to direct users to the course page after signing in via SSO.

Publishing a course for external users

Before publishing a course to be visible for external users, check the content thoroughly to ensure it fits within GitLab's SAFE framework. The steps needed to publish a course externally are:

1. From the admin view, navigate to the course by choosing Content > Manage Content, then finding the relevant course
1. Once in the course editor, in the Content page check all relevant changes have been published.
1. Go to the Design page then Edit Catalog Settings. Add the Public tag and click Save
1. Now go to the Release page. Click the Release button in the top right corner.
1. Your content is now visible in the public catalogue.

Share a course link with users external to GitLab

1. Add <https://levelup.gitlab.com/access/openid/login/?returnTo=immediately> before a course link to direct users to the course page after signing in via SSO.

Roles

Some users may need to have elevated permissions in the platform to perform specific functions like reporting or creating content. Here's some information about how to assign new roles, and create dual roles for users.

Dual Roles

Users can either be Managers in the platform or Learners. Managers have access to the backend admin options, Learners to the frontend learning experience. Therefore, if you are elevating a users permissions so they have access to admin options, it's important you remember to assign them a Dual Role.

We are currently reviewing the process for assigning dual role users, due to some SSO & API requirements.

Content

Content Types

Several different content types are available to use as templates in Level Up choosing the right content type is important for formatting your content, but also for reporting. Choosing the right content type for building out your learning material is important both for providing the right template & format for your content, but also for reporting and for letting learners know what type of content they can expect when choosing a learning item, e.g. a LinkedIn Learning Course, a Video, or a SCORM course.

Existing content types in the platform are as follows:

- Course
- SCORM
- Blog
- VILT
- Micro Course
- Video
- Certification Exam
- LinkedIn Learning Course

- Self-paced
- ILT
- Certified Training Partner Kit
- Education Services Customer ILT Event
- External Training

To create a new content type:

1. Access the Level Up Admin view.
1. In the side bar, click Settings, then Content, then Content Types.
1. In the top right hand corner, click, Add Content Type.
1. Fill in the details for your new content type, and choose a template based off one of the existing content types in the platform. When you've added all relevant information, click Save.
1. Now, when you go to add a new item of content, you will be able to select your new content type as an option from which to start building.

Page Types

Level Up's native content creation functionality allows for complex course creation using a variety of content types in order to help create learning experiences that are varied, interactive, and fun. Here are a list of the different page types that you can utilise when creating a course in Level Up

Content Pages

- Text - Add a page of simple text using a WYSIWYG editor to include images, links, embeds, etc. within the page. Used to embed handbook pages within an iframe.
- Slideshow - Create your own in-platform slide deck with text, audio and images.
- Presentation - Upload existing presentations or slides with accompanying audio files/ text for each slide.
- Video - Present learners with video content along with captions and additional text.
- List Roll - Present large amounts of content in a clear list and topic format.
- PDF Viewer - Share and display PDF files directly after one easy upload.
- Audio - Upload an audio file with a single image.

Interactive Pages

- Interactive - Breakdown an image into multiple parts using interactive hotspots
- Assignemnt - Create, assign and collect work for learners
- Flip Cards - Present content and imagery using interactive tiles that learners can click on to flip
- Note Book. - Give your learner the ability to take notes or reflect on content privately within a course
- Highlight Zones - Present learners with an interactive image with additional context
- Highlight Zone Challenge - Challenge learners using an interactive image with headers as clues
- Match Pairs - Engage learners to match associated content cards. This also makes for a great study tool.
- Discussion Board - Prompt discussions among learners using discussion prompts.

Assessment Pages

- Quiz - Assess learner knowledge added teaching tools like hints, multiple attempts and the ability to review assessment results.
- Test - Assess your learners knowledge and allow them to review their results after completion.
- Survey - Collect learner feedback through a configurable assessment.
- Reflection - Create a virtual or printable reflection for your learners to use as a learning or organizational tool.
- Tally - Use this score tier based assessment tool to present information that varies based on learner selected responses.

Other

- SCORM / xAPI - Present an embedded SCORM file or set it to launch in a new window.
- HTML Embed - Create a page from scratch or embed 3rd party content using HTML.

Manually assigning completion to a user

1. Go to Users > Learners and search for the relevant user
1. Click their name to enter their profile
1. Click Access and in the Search for Content to Add box, search for the content you want to add completion for.
1. The content should appear under the Has access to the following content.
1. Once the content has appeared (or if it was already there), select Completed from the dropdown and click Save
1. If the course had an associated certificate, this can also be manually attributed. Go to the Activity tab in the user profile after following the above steps, find the relevant Certificate then click Issue Certificate. This will trigger an email being sent to the user to notify them of the certificate being awarded.

Reporting

If you're looking for a basic overview of reporting, a good place to start is the Reporting Hub course in the Thought Industries academy training platform.

Creating a completion report

Here's a simple video tutorial on how to create a completion report for a content item in Level Up. It's privately listed, so you'll need to be signed in to GitLab Unfiltered to view it.

Here's a step by step guide:

1. In the Level Up Admin panel, navigate to Reporting > Explore
1. Under the Learner Content & Progress heading, select the What % complete are my learners with a particular item? report.
1. In the Filters at the top of page, use the Learner Content Details Content Title to search for the piece of content you'd like to report on.
1. From the list of fields on the left hand side, expand Learner Content and click Status. This will add in the status of whether a Learner is not-started, started, or completed. This is

important as any learners who completed in our previous learning system will show as completed, but have 0% progress, so should still be captured.

1. Add any other fields you think would be useful to include.

1. Click Run

1. To download the report, click the cog icon in the top right to open a dropdown menu. Then click Download.

1. In the new menu that pops up, update the file format (usually to CSV), and ensure you choose All Results option for Limit. Click Download

This is a way to create a simple completion report, remember there are lots of other criteria and information to utilise when putting reports together.

Using Google Sheets to share completion reporting with the business

Here is an example of a pivot chart that breaks down completions by division. Make a copy of this template and follow the steps below to build your own.

1. Submit an access request for a Wokrday report that includes manager name, division, department, and manager name. Add this data into the first tab in a Google sheet. Title it User Workday Data

1. Pull a completion report from Level Up for any course or content item. Download this completion data into the second tab in the same Google sheet. Title it as [Course Name]

1. To combine the User Workday Data shee and the [Course Name] sheet:

1. Ensure there is a column in the [Course Name] sheet that is titled Completed and has a 1 value for each user who has completed the course.

1. Create a new column in the User Workday Data tab called Completions.

1. Apply the formula =IF(ISNUMBER(MATCH(X10,Course Name!A:A,0)),1,0) to the column, where X is the column letter for Completed from the [Course Name] sheet, and Course Name is the exact title of the [Course Name] tab.

1. Drag the formula to apply to all rows in the User Workday Data sheet.

1. Add one new column in the User Workday Data sheet called Division Total and populate every row with a 1 value.

1. To create the pivot chart

1. Open a 3rd tab in the same sheet titled Completions by X depending on how you plan to sort the data.

1. Go to Insert then select Pivot Table and add it to the existing sheet

1. Apply Division as your Rows value

1. Apply your choice of values for each column. Most common will be Completions and Division Total

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/manager-development/_index.md

Your first few months as a manager at GitLab can be exhilarating. They can also be challenging, especially when you need to quickly identify what is important for your success.

Some of the challenges you might face are:

- Navigating changing relationships
- Finding the balance between managing and contributing

- Using delegation effectively
- Making strategic decisions
- Finding resources and support

Research by HR consultancy DDI has shown, that your transition may be one of the most demanding life experiences that you will ever endure. However, the satisfaction of leading teams to success makes that journey worthwhile and inspiring.

To reach that success, you will need a network of support, templates, tools, and training. At GitLab, we develop and iterate upon an engaging pathway that enables managers to lead teams to success. This pathway begins with a Becoming a GitLab Manager issue. This checklist will ensure that, as a new manager, you have a strong foundation, with all the tactical resources available. The Learning and Development team, your leader, and a peer network of experienced colleagues are ready to support you.

Finding the balance between contributing and managing

Let's take a closer look at just two of the challenges you might face. The first is finding a balance between contributing and managing.

By doing too much of the team's work yourself, you may deprive team members of the means to improve themselves and make them overly dependent upon you. You also risk facing burnout. One solution is to change the way you contribute to your employees' efforts. Instead of doing a piece of work for them, ask them to take small iterative steps.

For example, a team member has a project but has no idea where to start, so they ask you for help.

You could show them how you would start it, but that could lead to a long-term dependency. Your team may internalize that they should always ask you before starting something. Instead, try telling them that they should comment an issue with five ideas by 10 a.m. the next day, and you will respond with your comments/suggestions by 10 a.m. the following day. This may be the same amount of work for you at first, but over time it will shift. Your team will begin to take smaller steps on their own, and allow you more time to focus on providing guidance and course correction. By taking this approach, you will help your team learn how to best prioritize and plan their work, which will help them to successfully execute their goals.

Navigating the complexity of managing your former peers

If you have been promoted to a manager role, a second challenge you might face is navigating the complexity of managing your former peers.

The key to making this transition smooth is to be inclusive and communicate with your team and external collaborators. During your first few weeks as a new manager, try to identify a few small decisions you can make fairly quickly, but defer bigger ones until you've been in the role longer and have time to gather input from everyone. For example, set up a new schedule and agenda for team meetings, this is a small change but it clearly establishes your role as manager.

Also, in the first few weeks, take actions that establish your credibility and indicate how

you'll work as a manager. One of the best ways is to meet with your team, as a group and individually, and share with them your management style or review your Manager README. Meeting with the team will help you to identify their motivators so that you can start working with the team to create more informed individual and team goals.

During this type of transition, it's easy to become overly focused on your former peers. Don't forget to build relationships with your new leader and schedule coffee chats with other stakeholders across the organization.

The "Becoming a GitLab Manager" issue, support, and resources

There are many more challenges that you could face as a new manager. The goal of this program is to provide a foundation for your success and enable you to overcome those challenges.

As a manager, you can lead your team to learn, grow and succeed. Following their progress and acknowledging their development can be the most rewarding aspect of your work. As issues arise, you can lean on a support network and receive guidance from experienced colleagues. This support consists of recurring Managers' coffee chats, dedicated slack channels, training modules, templates, leaders/mentors, and People Ops Business Partners all ready to answer questions and provide you with guidance.

The Becoming a GitLab Manager issue is a launchpad, and it can connect you with crucial information about being a manager at GitLab. This issue is created automatically during the career mobility process, however, you can also assign it to yourself (Please ensure you use your legal name in the title). It is designed to ensure you start your journey as a manager with all the resources training available. This checklist will evolve as we iterate upon it and continue to build this program. Your contributions as a new manager are essential, please submit a merge request with ideas for improvement.

If you have questions as you work your way through this checklist please ask them in managers Slack channel.

Becoming a GitLab Manager Issue Retr